ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE AA

Vote YES on AA **to repair aging La Mesa-Spring Valley schools WITHOUT INCREASING TAX RATES.**

Our children need safe and up-to-date classrooms — not leaky roofs, failing pipes, outdated electrical systems, and classrooms with temperatures above 90 degrees. While our schools are well maintained, most local schools were built **more than 60 years ago and need urgent repairs and upgrades.**

Voting YES on AA repairs and upgrades our elementary and middle schools WITHOUT INCREASING TAX RATES. Measure AA simply **extends the current tax rate** previously approved by voters **without an increase.**

This fiscally responsible plan upgrades our schools before the repairs become more expensive. Voting YES also helps our schools **qualify for up to $61,000,000 in state matching funds** that will otherwise go to schools in other communities. That's why **the San Diego County Taxpayers Association endorses Measure AA.**

Measure AA will:

- Repair deteriorating roofs, plumbing, sewer, electrical, and HVAC systems
- Protect students from extreme heat with air conditioning and shade structures
- Improve campus security with locks, cameras, emergency communications, smoke detectors, fire alarms, and sprinklers
- Remove hazardous materials like asbestos and lead pipes and improve access for students with disabilities
- Upgrade classrooms, labs, technology, and multipurpose rooms for math, science, reading, writing, arts, and music

Measure AA requires **strict fiscal accountability protections** to ensure all funds stay local and are spent as promised, including:

- A detailed project list and required public disclosure of all spending
- An independent oversight committee and annual audits
- All funds must be locally controlled and cannot be taken by the state or federal government
- No funds can be used for employee salaries or benefits

Whether or not you have school-age children, **strong schools protect home values, strengthen neighborhoods, and improve quality of life** for students, families, and the entire community.

Vote YES on AA **to repair aging schools WITHOUT INCREASING TAX RATES.**

DR. MARK ARAPOSTATHIS
Mayor of La Mesa, Retired LMSVSD Teacher, Lifelong La Mesa Resident

MARK KERSEY
President & CEO, San Diego County Taxpayers Association

CHRISTINA HICKS
PTA Council President & LMSVSD Parent

KATHY SHEETS
President, La Mesa-Spring Valley Teachers Association

AHMAD SWINTON
California School Employees Association Chapter President & LMSVSD Parent

No Argument Against Measure AA was filed with the Office of the Registrar of Voters

FULL TEXT OF MEASURE AA

The following is the full proposition presented to the voters by the La Mesa-Spring Valley School District (the "District"). In connection with this bond proposition, the Board of Education (the "Board") of the District has made the following findings:

FINDINGS

- The District provides quality education for more than 10,000 local students in preschool through eighth grade that prepares them for success in high school, college and future careers.
- With most local schools built more than 60 years ago, the District is working to ensure all students learn in classrooms that meet current educational standards as well as fire, earthquake, security and safety standards.
- Some schools were built so long ago that underground clay and cast-iron pipes and infrastructure are failing, resulting in gas leaks, water leaks and sewage backups.
- During warmer months, classroom temperatures can exceed 90 degrees, requiring air conditioning and outdoor shade structures to keep students cool and safe.
- A thorough assessment of each classroom and school facility has identified high-priority repairs and upgrades.
- The District has developed a thorough and comprehensive Facilities Master Plan to complete the highest priority repairs and upgrades needed at each school campus.
- Because the State does not provide dedicated funding to school districts for repairing and upgrading school facilities and bond measures are the primary means by which local school districts fund these needs, the Board believes that locally controlled funding from a school improvement bond measure is needed to repair and upgrade aging local schools.
- With an old bond measure set to expire, the District has an opportunity to issue new bonds by extending, but not increasing, the tax rate paid by local property owners.
- The proposed bond extension measure is not projected to increase tax rates beyond the amount local property owners currently pay.
- If approved by local voters, the extension measure would generate $131 million in locally controlled funding by extending the current bond tax rate previously approved by voters.
- Funding from the extension measure would be used to repair or replace deteriorating roofs, plumbing, sewer and electrical systems.
- Funds from the extension measure would also install shade structures and air conditioning to protect students from extreme heat.
- Funds from the extension measure would improve student safety and campus security, including security locks, emergency communications systems, security cameras, smoke detectors, fire alarms and sprinklers.
- Funds from the extension measure would upgrade classrooms, labs, technology and multipurpose rooms to support programs in math, science, reading, writing, arts and music.
- Funds from the extension measure would remove hazardous materials like asbestos and lead pipes from older schools, and upgrade older schools to meet current health codes, building safety codes and improve access for students with disabilities.
- Voter approval of the bond extension measure will help local schools qualify for an estimated $61 million in state matching funds that will otherwise will go to improve schools in other communities.